

MODULE ONE

1. Revisiting the Concept of the Total Man

A. What is the “Total Man”?

The “Total Man” refers to the **holistic nature of human beings**—created by God as an integrated unity of:

- **Spirit**
- **Soul**
- **Body**

This is often called the **tripartite nature of man** in Christian theology.

Key Scripture:

“May your whole spirit, soul and body be kept blameless...”

— 1 Thessalonians 5:23

This verse is foundational—it explicitly presents the human being as a **three-dimensional entity**.

B. The Origin of the Total Man

Creation Model

“The Lord God formed man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life...”

— Genesis 2:7

From this we see:

- **Body** → formed from dust
- **Spirit** → breath from God
- **Soul** → the resulting “living being” (personality, consciousness)

Teaching Insight:

The Total Man is not three separate beings, but **one integrated person expressing life through three dimensions**.

C. Components of the Total Man

1. The Spirit (God-consciousness)

- The part that **relates to God**
- Receives divine revelation and spiritual life

Scriptures:

- “God is Spirit...” — John 4:24
- “The Spirit Himself bears witness with our spirit...” — Romans 8:16

Key Functions:

- Worship
- Communion with God
- Spiritual perception

2. The Soul (Self-consciousness)

The soul is the **seat of personality**, consisting of:

- **Mind** (thinking)
- **Will** (decision-making)
- **Emotions** (feelings)

Scriptures:

- “As a man thinks in his heart, so is he...” — Proverbs 23:7
- “Bless the Lord, O my soul...” — Psalms 103:1

Key Functions:

- Reasoning
- Choosing
- Feeling

3. The Body (World-consciousness)

- The physical structure that connects man to the **material world**

Scriptures:

- “Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit...” — 1 Corinthians 6:19
- “Present your bodies as a living sacrifice...” — Romans 12:1

Key Functions:

- Sensory interaction
- Action and expression
- Earthly stewardship

D. The Unity of the Total Man

A critical correction at this level:

Do **not** teach the parts as independent compartments.

Key Idea:

The Total Man is **integrated, not fragmented**.

Scripture:

“Love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, mind, and strength...”

— Mark 12:30

This shows:

- God expects **total engagement**, not partial devotion.

E. The Fall and Its Effect on the Total Man

What changed?

After sin (Genesis 3):

- **Spirit** → disconnected from God (spiritual death)
- **Soul** → corrupted (confusion, instability)
- **Body** → subject to decay and death

Supporting Scripture:

- “The wages of sin is death...” — Romans 6:23

F. Redemption and Restoration of the Total Man

Salvation addresses **all three dimensions**, but in stages:

1. Spirit → Regenerated instantly

- John 3:6

2. Soul → Being renewed progressively

- Romans 12:2

3. Body → Will be glorified

- 1 Corinthians 15:44

G. Theological Models (Advanced Discussion)

At 400 level, introduce debate:

1. Trichotomy (Spirit, Soul, Body distinct)

- Supported by 1 Thessalonians 5:23

2. Dichotomy (Soul & Spirit interchangeable)

- Supported by passages like Hebrews 4:12

Teaching Tip:

All students are to:

- Compare texts
- Analyze original Greek terms (*psyche*, *pneuma*)
- Develop a reasoned theological stance

H. Practical Implications for the Total Man

1. Spiritual growth must be holistic

- Not just prayer (spirit), but also mindset (soul) and discipline (body)

2. Imbalance leads to dysfunction

- Over-spiritualizing → neglect of intellect/body

- Over-intellectualizing → spiritual dryness
- 3. **Ministry must address the whole person**
 - Counseling, discipleship, healing, ethics

Closing Thought

The goal is not just to understand the Total Man—but to become **a fully aligned person** where:

- Spirit is submitted to God
- Soul is renewed by truth
- Body is disciplined for purpose